

THE DARK HIERARCHY

A Metaphysics of Desire, Authority, and Erotic Custody

ECHO KRONBORG · CARRIER OF DECHO · BERLIN

Desire is not only what you feel toward another person, but what you feel about yourself in their presence.

A completed work of erotic philosophy, speculative theology, and field testimony that challenges the Lacanian doctrine of lack from inside lived hierarchical practice. Five books and a coda, typeset as a 6 × 9 in trade volume, with a seven-instrument digital companion that gives every reader a private way back into the argument.

396 PAGES	72,148 WORDS	5 + Coda BOOKS	21 MOVEMENTS	7 INSTRUMENTS	53 SCHOLARLY NOTES
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The audience is measurable, and large

Independent research and event data show that the book’s subject is not a fringe curiosity. Third-party figures below are market context, with sources on page 2; they are not projections for this title.

46.8% OF BELGIAN ADULTS had performed at least one BDSM-related activity; 12.5% do so regularly and 7.6% self-identify as practitioners. ¹	Nearly half OF QUEBEC ADULTS expressed interest in at least one paraphilic category; about a third had experience of one (n = 1,040). ²	about 20,000 FOLSOM EUROPE, BERLIN visitors from six continents at the 2025 edition (the 21st), per the organiser. ³
about 20,000 DARKLANDS, ANTWERP visitors at the 2024 edition (the 14th), per Belgian broadcaster VRT. ⁴	27,000 DARKLANDS 2025, EXPECTED visitors over five days, from 74 countries, per VRT. ⁴	165M+ FIFTY SHADES, COPIES sold worldwide per its publisher: proof of mass readership for the subject, in a very different register. ⁵

Six readerships, one book

- Leather, kink and BDSM communities, and households practising hierarchy: the book is written from inside this world.

— Continental philosophy and critical theory readers, the Semiotext(e) and Repeater constituency: Lacan, Bataille, Bersani, Han, Weil, Foucault.

— Queer and gender-studies scholars and students: a full theoretical apparatus and glossary, a scholarly engagement with more than 25 named thinkers and traditions, and a 15-week seminar syllabus.
- Spiritual and pastoral readers: liturgy, canticles, and dark-night material engage Weil, Otto, Turner, Nouwen, and Loder.

— Cultural programming audiences in Berlin and Northern Europe: festivals, galleries, reading series, and philosophy nights.

— BDSM-ethnography readers: the apparatus engages Margot Weiss, Gayle Rubin, and Staci Newmahr directly.

Six story angles for press

- “Against Lacan, from inside the dungeon.” A theory book that tests its argument against lived practice rather than the clinic.
- A book with a free reflection service. Seven instruments, a choice between this device only and a code that works anywhere, no analytics or tracking cookies, an 18+ gate. The only return asked is anonymous, rounded counters for research that identify no one.
- The author audits himself. The book is “not a confession; it is version control,” and its twentieth movement analyses the author’s own relationship record.
- “God has two neighbors: Order and Humor.” Bergman’s dictum turned into a household philosophy: quotable, funny, serious.
- Berlin as a leather capital. A natural partner for Folsom Europe week and the city’s fetish and queer cultural calendar.
- Consent as theology. Revocability and autonomy are stated as preconditions on page one, answering the “is this safe?” question before it is asked.

Four returns from one work

PUBLICATIONS

Monograph, validation paper, replication, practitioner companion.

SCIENCE

Six falsifiable hypotheses; anonymous-by-design counters, live; open to institutional co-projects.

REFLECTION

Seven private instruments that give readers value the same day.

TURNKEY PR

Try it in minutes, share a comparison link, scan the QR on p. 323.

Programming and partnerships

- Reading series and philosophy nights built around single movements: the 21-movement structure is modular.
- Festival and gallery talks in the Folsom Europe and Darklands orbit, subject to invitation and partner programming.
- University adoption: a 15-week graduate syllabus (Philosophy / GSWS) is included in the proposal kit.
- Instrument-led workshops: each of the seven tools is a 5–12 minute reflective exercise (115 prompts in total) that can anchor a session.

What the product team can expect

Is the manuscript finished?

Yes. Release edition v124, 396 pages, 0 errors, 0 undefined references. Full PDF on request. Neither DSM-5 nor ICD-11 counts consensual practice as a disorder.⁶

Is there a digital product to launch with?

Yes, live at echoxstudios.art/tdh: seven instruments, shareable partner comparison, private retrieval codes, optional emailed results.

Is it responsibly built?

Adults only; the reader chooses between a code that works on any device (explicit consent), this device only, or nothing saved; no marketing cookies; no result statistics sent for analytics; non-diagnostic by design.

What we do not claim. No clinical validity. No sales forecast. No claim that the Echo-System has collected research data, or that the reference overlay is a census. Third-party figures describe the wider field, not this title’s expected reach.

SOURCES, ACCESSED 3 OCTOBER 2026

1. Holvoet L. et al., “Fifty Shades of Belgian Gray: The Prevalence of BDSM-Related Fantasies and Activities in the General Population,” *Journal of Sexual Medicine* 14, 2017, 1152–1159. pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/28781214
2. Joyal C.C. & Carpentier J., “The Prevalence of Paraphilic Interests and Behaviors in the General Population: A Provincial Survey,” *Journal of Sex Research* 54(2), 2017, 161–171. pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/26941021 (figures as stated in the abstract).
3. FOLSOM Europe e.V., 2025 edition, as listed at festivalsindeutschland.de/festival/folsom-europe-berlin/2025 (organiser figure: about 20,000 visitors from six continents; 21st edition).
4. VRT NWS, 1 March 2024 (Darklands 2024, about 20,000 visitors, 14th edition) and 28 February 2025 (Darklands 2025, 27,000 expected over five days, 74 countries).
5. Penguin Random House, Fifty Shades of Grey series page (“more than 165 million copies sold worldwide”).
6. APA, *DSM-5*, 2013; Krueger R.B. et al., *Archives of Sexual Behavior* 46, 2017, 1529–1545 (ICD-11). Both cited in the book.

Request the manuscript and submission package

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